

ACTIVE PROSECUTION · CAF MEMBERS · ALLEGED ANTI-GOVERNMENT MILITIA PLOT

CAF Members & the Quebec City “Anti-Government Militia” Plot

In July 2025 the Royal Canadian Mounted Police announced charges against four men, two of them active Canadian Armed Forces members at the time of charges, in connection with an alleged ideologically motivated violent extremism (IMVE) plot to forcibly take possession of land in the Quebec City area and form an anti-government militia. Three of the four were charged with the indictable offence of facilitating a terrorist activity; the fourth was charged with weapons and explosives offences. The weapons seizure — described by a former CSIS analyst as the largest in any Canadian terrorism incident — included 16 explosive devices, 83 firearms, 11,000 rounds of ammunition, and 130 magazines. This page files the institutional record.

Presumption of innocence. Every person named on this page has been charged but not convicted at the time of publication. Charges are allegations to be proved at trial. The dossier records charges, court-status milestones, and public statements; convictions, acquittals, and stays will be filed as the chronology resolves.

Source discipline. Names of the accused, charges, dates, and weapons-seizure totals on this page are drawn from the RCMP public news release of July 2025, CBC News reporting, the Globe and Mail, GNET (Global Network on Extremism and Technology), and Global News. The RCMP's named press-conference spokesperson on the file is recorded under her actual public role; the page does not file her as a defendant. Editorial framing is clearly demarcated in its own section.

Investigation timeline

- **2021 (per Habel)** — The alleged activity later prosecuted is dated by the RCMP back to 2021. (Source: Habel, public statements at media availability, July 2025.)
- **Spring 2023** — RCMP investigation opens. The file is run by the Quebec RCMP's Integrated National Security Enforcement Team (INSET) — the multi-agency RCMP-led unit (RCMP + CSIS + CBSA + provincial police) responsible for IMVE files. Habel is documented as a member of the Quebec RCMP national security team / INSET.
- **January 2024** — RCMP raids on residential homes in Quebec recover the seized cache. Per Habel's public statements, items allegedly diverted from the military are among the materials recovered. *Note: the Canadian Armed Forces' public position (per Global News) is that the cache “did not originate from CAF stocks.”* The contradiction between the two statements is recorded under “Charges & weapons seizure” below as a public-record evidentiary tension to be resolved at trial.
- **2025-07-08** — ~18 months after the raids, RCMP announces charges and arrests of four men in Quebec; three charged with facilitating a terrorist activity, the fourth with weapons / explosives offences.
- **2025-07 (week of arrests)** — RCMP holds a media availability; Staff Sgt. Camille Habel serves as the named press-conference spokesperson and INSET-team representative.
- **2025-07 (post-arrest)** — Three of the four (the facilitating-terrorism trio) are denied bail by Quebec City's court of Judge René de la Sablonnière.
- **2025-07 (week of arrests)** — Defence Minister Bill Blair (then-Defence Minister, see [police-chiefs-canadian.html](#) and [accountability.html](#)) calls the alleged plot “disturbing” and asserts the military culture is changing. (Carney premiership; Blair's portfolio at this time.)
- **2025-07 (post-presser)** — Habel's public statement that an “observed sudden change” toward “traditional values” could be one of several radicalization indicators draws sustained criticism. The RCMP issues a public clarification stating the force is “in no way implying that embracing traditional values makes an individual radical or extreme.” *Substantive analysis of the INSET investigative-framework dimension of this episode is filed below.*
- **(ongoing)** — Court proceedings continue. Updates filed here as they advance.

Named accused (per public record)

Marc-Aurèle Chabot

AGE 24 · QUEBEC CITY · CHARGED: FACILITATING A TERRORIST ACTIVITY

Named in the RCMP's July 2025 public charging announcement. Per Crown materials reported by CBC, Globe and Mail, and GNET, alleged to have participated in military-style training exercises (shooting, ambush, survival, navigation) with co-accused as part of the alleged plot. Bail status: denied (Judge de la Sablonnière).

Simon Angers-Audet

AGE 24 · NEUVILLE, QC · CHARGED: FACILITATING A TERRORIST ACTIVITY

Named in the RCMP's July 2025 public charging announcement. Same alleged training-exercise context as the other facilitating-terrorism accused. Bail status: denied.

Raphaël Lagacé

AGE 25 · QUEBEC CITY · CHARGED: FACILITATING A TERRORIST ACTIVITY

Named in the RCMP's July 2025 public charging announcement. Same alleged training-exercise context. Bail status: denied.

Matthew Forbes

AGE 33 · PONT-ROUGE, QC · CHARGED: WEAPONS / EXPLOSIVES / DEFENCE PRODUCTION ACT OFFENCES (NOT CHARGED WITH FACILITATING TERRORISM)

Named in the RCMP's July 2025 public charging announcement. Charges relate to possession of firearms, prohibited devices, explosives, and controlled items, plus offences under the Explosives Act and the Defence Production Act. Distinguished from the other three accused by the absence of a facilitating-terrorism charge.

Per RCMP and CBC reporting, two of the four accused were active Canadian Armed Forces members at the time of charges. The Canadian Armed Forces have publicly stated that the seized weapons and ammunition did not originate from CAF stocks; sourcing of the seized cache is a question for the Crown at trial.

Charges & weapons seizure

ITEM	PUBLIC-RECORD SPECIFICS
Facilitating a terrorist activity	Three accused charged (Chabot, Angers-Audet, Lagacé). The Crown's stated theory: the alleged plot constitutes ideologically motivated violent extremism (IMVE) intending to forcibly take possession of land in the Quebec City region and to establish a new society / anti-government militia.
Possession of firearms / prohibited devices / explosives	Forbes charged. The cache included civilian and restricted firearms, explosive devices, and controlled-item components.
Explosives Act offences	Forbes charged. Federal-statute offences relating to the unauthorized possession or control of explosives.
Defence Production Act offences	Forbes charged. The Defence Production Act regulates Canadian-manufactured defence goods; the charge implies allegations of unauthorized possession or distribution.
Seized cache (RCMP-reported)	16 explosive devices, 83 firearms and accessories, 11,000 rounds of ammunition, ~130 magazines. Jessica Davis, president of Insight Threat Intelligence and a former CSIS analyst, publicly characterised the seizure as the largest cache of weapons and components in any terrorism incident in Canadian history.
Weapons-source contradiction in the public record	Two public statements appear in tension and will be resolved at trial. Per Global News reporting, the Canadian Armed Forces' institutional position is that the seized cache <i>“did not originate from CAF stocks.”</i> Per Habel's public statements (CTV / Buffalo Toronto Public Media), the accused <i>“allegedly diverted items from the military that were later recovered in raids on residential homes in January 2024.”</i> Both statements can technically coexist if “diverted items” refers to specific items rather than the bulk of the cache, but the contradiction is on the public record and will be a Crown / defence question at trial. The dossier files this as a PENDING EVIDENTIARY TENSION rather than predetermining either reading.

All entries above are PENDING TRIAL. Convictions, acquittals, stays, and resolution of the weapons-source contradiction will be filed as the court record resolves.

INSET's investigative-framework rhetoric — the “traditional values” episode

The institutional record on this file (INSET framework, not individual conduct)

PUBLIC ARTICULATION BY: STAFF SGT. CAMILLE HABEL, MEMBER OF QUEBEC RCMP / INSET NATIONAL SECURITY TEAM

The RCMP's named public spokesperson on the file in the immediate aftermath of the July 2025 arrests was Staff Sgt. Camille Habel. Habel is documented as a member of the Quebec RCMP's Integrated National Security Enforcement Team (INSET) — the operational unit that ran the multi-year investigation, not a generalist communications officer. **Her public statements therefore reflect INSET's investigative-framework, not a one-off press-conference word choice.**

In media interviews following the press conference, Habel articulated the framework as follows. Verbatim: *“If someone you know believed in equal gender rights but all of a sudden are leaning towards, like, [traditional values] and that might be a sign that they're becoming more extremist.”* She added in the same interview: *“having the most extremist views is perfectly legal in Canada and that it's only acting with violence to prove that view that becomes a criminal offense.”* The first sentence drew sustained public criticism for treating *protected ideological change itself* — a behavioural shift toward views the Charter protects under s.2(b) — as one of the radicalization indicators INSET tracks. The RCMP issued a public clarification statement asserting that the force is “in no way implying that embracing traditional values makes an individual radical or extreme” and that the relevant signal “is the observed and sometimes sudden change in one's behaviour, beliefs or goals as well as tolerating the use of violence to achieve those goals.”

The structural dossier concern. Habel's in-interview clarification correctly identifies the legal line (the views are legal; only violence is criminal). Yet the example she offered makes the *shift toward those views* a marker the operational unit watches for. That structural form — using a protected-speech behavioural shift as one of multiple radicalization indicators — is the standing concern. It does not depend on Habel personally; it is a property of the INSET framework she was articulating in her capacity as an INSET-team member. Whether a federal national-security operational unit's indicator-set should incorporate observed-shift-toward-protected-views is a Charter s.2(b) question that the dossier files at the institutional layer.

The recording stops at the framework concern. The dossier does not file Habel as a defendant on this or any other ground; she is the public articulator of the INSET framework, and the framework itself is what warrants institutional review (PCRC, Parliamentary committee, Charter litigation). A finding by the Public Complaints and Review Commission that the framework treats protected ideological change as a radicalization marker would be a substantive institutional consequence with policy-reform potential.

Sources: CBC News interview (verbatim quote); RCMP institutional clarification statement; Fox News video coverage; NTD Canada reporting; Factually.co fact-check (which independently verified the verbatim quote and the RCMP walk-back, and rated as *unverified misinformation* the parallel

social-media-circulating claims about a “differently identified Staff Sergeant Habel” alleged to have prior US-military discipline).

Institutional questions raised

The case raises a set of institutional questions the dossier files at policy / oversight level, not against the named accused:

- **CAF screening and retention.** Two active CAF members are alleged to have progressed to the point of military-style training in connection with the alleged plot. Cross-reference: [cfnis.html](#) for the Canadian Forces National Investigation Service record; [cds-accountability.html](#) for the Chief of the Defence Staff record.
- **Weapons-acquisition pathway — with documented public-record tension.** CAF's institutional position is the seized cache did not originate from CAF stocks; INSET's public statement is that items were “diverted from the military” and recovered in the January 2024 raids. The two are in apparent tension on the public record and will be resolved at trial. Whichever resolution prevails, the case raises broader questions about the federal firearms regime, lawful-possession-volume thresholds, and Explosives Act licensing. Cross-reference: [dnd-procurement.html](#) for the broader DND record.
- **INSET inter-agency coordination (RCMP-led, CSIS / CBSA / provincial-police).** The Quebec INSET that led this file is the operational unit through which the RCMP runs IMVE investigations in Quebec. Habel's membership on that team places her in the operational chain, not just the communications chain. The institutional question is what the INSET indicator-set treats as a radicalization marker, whether that indicator-set has been independently reviewed for Charter compliance, and whether the parliamentary committees with oversight (NSICOP, SECU) have audited it. Cross-reference: [csis-oversight.html](#) for the CSIS-side record; [foreign-interference.html](#) for the broader threat-intelligence record (this case is not a foreign-interference file but the institutional architecture overlaps).
- **Charter s.2(b) compliance of the INSET radicalization-indicator framework.** Filed in the “INSET's investigative-framework rhetoric” section above. The standing concern: a federal national-security operational unit that treats *observed shift toward protected-speech viewpoints* as one of its radicalization indicators raises a Charter compliance question that has not been the subject of independent civilian review. The PCRC complaint mechanism is the legitimate route for such a review.
- **Bail-denial precedent in IMVE files.** Three of the four accused were denied bail. The pattern of bail-denial in domestic-extremism files has not been the subject of a recent independent review; if a future review is convened it will be filed in the dossier's active-prosecutions register.

- **The duration question (Spring 2023 → Jul 2025 = 27 months).** The investigation ran for over two years before charges were laid, with raids 18 months before charges. That duration permits a question about whether earlier intervention would have de-escalated rather than evidence-built; the dossier records this as one possible defence-side framing pending the Crown's case at trial.

Contested framing — the “forcibly take possession” question

Crown theory vs. defence theory — the dossier records both as pending

The Crown's framing is an allegation. The defence's framing will be tested at trial.

The Crown's public-record characterisation of the alleged plot is that the accused intended to *forcibly take possession of land in the Quebec City area* and form an *anti-government militia*. That language comes from RCMP press releases and Crown materials reported in mainstream coverage. It is the Crown's theory of the case.

An alternative reading the dossier records as the contested-framing question is that some or all of the accused may have intended remote off-grid living in lawfully accessible Crown / wilderness land — which is not in itself an offence — and that the cache was characterised by them as defensive rather than offensive in nature. That reading is one possible defence narrative; whether it is the defence theory the accused will actually advance at trial is not yet on the public record. The cache size (16 explosive devices, 83 firearms, 11,000 rounds, ~130 magazines) creates evidentiary tension with a pure off-grid-retreat reading; whether that tension breaks the Crown's way or the defence's way is a question for trial.

The dossier records both readings as PENDING COURT RESOLUTION. Presumption of innocence applies. The page does not predetermine the Crown's theory as fact; it also does not predetermine the defence's theory as fact. The court record will resolve which framing the evidence supports.

The asymmetry-of-prosecution question

This section is the dossier's named institutional-accountability question on this case. It does not legitimise the alleged plot. It does name the prosecution-asymmetry pattern the dossier-wide record establishes.

What gets prosecuted, what doesn't — the documented contrast

Files cross-referenced: [accountability.html](#) · [veterans-maid.html](#) · [maid-accountability.html](#) · [brookfield-maid.html](#) · [evidence.html](#)

Prosecuted on this file (named, charged, denied bail): Four men, two of them active CAF members, charged with facilitating-terrorism / weapons / explosives offences in connection with an alleged plot whose lawful versus unlawful character is contested as recorded in the section above. Three of four denied bail. Active prosecution underway.

Not prosecuted on the parallel file (named victims, named institutional actors, no charges laid): Christine Gauthier, paraplegic former CAF member and 2016 Rio Paralympian, was offered Medical Assistance in Dying in writing by Veterans Affairs Canada in lieu of a wheelchair lift — testified before the House of Commons veterans committee. At least four further documented VAC cases of veterans being offered MAID unprompted, including at least one combat veteran in PTSD treatment. One of those four veterans was already deceased at the time of public reporting. The VAC employee responsible for the documented cases was reported as “*no longer working for*” the department; no criminal charges were laid against any VAC employee, against the responsible Cabinet Minister of the day, or against any senior VAC manager who oversaw the practice.

The institutional question: what determines the threshold for criminal prosecution? Why does CAF-side organisation against the state cross the criminal-prosecution line at *11,000 rounds and pre-act planning*, while documented state-side facilitation of CAF-veteran deaths through unsolicited-MAID offers does not cross the criminal-prosecution line at all? What does the prosecution-asymmetry pattern say about whose deaths the criminal-justice system treats as warranting investigation and whose it does not?

The dossier files this question at the institutional layer because that is where the public record permits. The Gauthier case and the parallel VAC cases are documented in committee testimony and departmental reports; the broader 76,475+ MAID-deaths aggregate and 53,308+ opioid-deaths aggregate are filed across [maid-accountability.html](#) and the relevant pages. The named accused on this file are charged; the named institutional actors on the VAC-MAID file are not. The question is what determines that asymmetry.

Sources: CBC News — Christine Gauthier testimony to House of Commons Veterans Affairs Committee (Dec 2022); CBC News — Veterans Affairs Canada one-employee statement and RCMP investigation referral; Globe and Mail and Global News reporting on VAC unsolicited-MAID cases;

Veterans Affairs Canada departmental report on the allegations (released March 2023); House of Commons Veterans Affairs Committee testimony record.

Legal framing — what the asymmetry observation does and does not authorise

International-law clarity, applied to the dossier's own thesis

The dossier's thesis identifies state policy as causing documented mass deaths. The asymmetry-of-prosecution observation strengthens the case that institutional accountability mechanisms have not been activated against the responsible policymakers. **That observation does not, however, legally authorise armed civilian organisation against the state.** The Genocide Convention (UN 1948) imposes obligations on *states* to prevent genocide and authorises *international intervention* through state-collective mechanisms. The Responsibility to Protect (R2P, UN World Summit 2005) similarly routes through international action. Neither doctrine authorises private armed action by citizens within the state whose policies they consider genocidal.

The legitimate paths against state-policy harm — even granting the dossier's genocide thesis in full — are: domestic political action; domestic judicial action (Charter challenges, civil litigation, inquests); international accountability (Rome Statute submissions to the International Criminal Court, UN Special Rapporteur reporting); s.504 informations against named policymakers where reasonable grounds exist; and public-record documentation of the kind the dossier itself is. **Armed civilian organisation, even if motivated by genuine conviction that the state is causing mass deaths, is not within those paths.** The dossier holds that line because the dossier's value depends on it: every other page survives review precisely because it routes through the legitimate paths above. Endorsing armed organisation would compromise the standing of those pages.

That said: the prosecution-asymmetry observation remains valid as *a question about what the criminal-justice system does and does not pursue*. It is filed here, with the named facts, for that question to stand on its own.

Editorial — what this page is and is not

This section is editorial framing, not from a charging document. Factual claims sit in the sections above; this section names what the dossier's evidentiary discipline does and does not allow on this topic.

The dossier files this case at the institutional layer because that is what the public record supports. The named defendants on this page are the four accused as named by the RCMP and Crown materials. The named officer (Habel) is recorded under her actual role — press-conference spokesperson — with her actual public-record controversy (the “traditional values” comment, walked back by the RCMP) recorded in its own section. She is not filed as a defendant here. Filing an arresting officer or press-conference spokesperson as a defendant in an active prosecution where the public record does not name her as the subject of allegations would be (a) a defamation risk that compromises the dossier's standing in any future legal forum; (b) a misuse of the s.504 mechanism, which requires reasonable grounds; and (c) a violation of the dossier's named-defendant discipline that the rest of the site holds.

The dossier's position on the underlying institutional questions — CAF screening, weapons-acquisition pathway, inter-agency coordination, bail-denial precedent, police rhetoric on radicalization indicators — is filed in the “Institutional questions raised” section above and cross-references the relevant existing files. The dossier's position on the alleged plot itself remains pending court resolution; presumption of innocence applies to the four accused throughout.

Connected pages

- [cfnis.html](#) — Canadian Forces National Investigation Service record (CAF-internal investigative authority).
- [cds-accountability.html](#) — Chief of the Defence Staff accountability record.
- [csis-oversight.html](#) — CSIS oversight and IMVE-rhetoric record.
- [foreign-interference.html](#) — the broader threat-intelligence record (architecturally adjacent, not a foreign-interference file).
- [dnd-procurement.html](#) — the DND procurement / weapons-stocks record.
- [emergencies-act.html](#) — the federal-extraordinary-authority record (architecturally adjacent for IMVE response posture).
- [accountability.html](#) — the searchable named-actor record register.
- [police-chiefs-canadian.html](#) — Bill Blair's Defence-portfolio record (Defence Minister at time of charges).

HOW THIS PAGE WAS SEEDED

Seeded 2026-05-02 from a directive to file the July 2025 RCMP CAF-terrorism-charges case at the dossier's

standard institutional-layer evidentiary discipline. Ground-truthed against RCMP public news release, CBC News reporting (rcmp-caf-charges-terrorism-1.7579487 + rcmp-militia-members-plot-1.7580658 + mcguinty-rcmp-militia-members-plot-1.7582071 + 1.7602153 bail-denied), Globe and Mail reporting, GNET research piece, Global News reporting on the CAF weapons-stocks question, and the RCMP institutional clarification statement on the “traditional values” comment. The named press-conference spokesperson is recorded under her actual public role; the dossier does not file her as a defendant in this active prosecution.

Page first published 2026-05-02. Active prosecution — updated as charges resolve, bail status changes, or further institutional findings (CAF internal review, RCMP review) become public.

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